

MODULE 00 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional

SAP-C02. What the exam actually tests, and how this course is built.

EXAM SAP-C02 QUESTIONS 75 in 180 min PASS 750 of 1000

Who this exam is for

- ◆ **AWS recommends two or more years of hands-on experience** designing and managing solutions on AWS. There are no formal prerequisites.
- ◆ **It tests judgement, not recall.** Most questions have two defensible answers and one that fits the stated constraint.
- ◆ **The stems are long.** A scenario runs to a paragraph or two, and the deciding detail is often one clause inside it.
- ◆ If you hold the Associate, expect a different exercise. This one is about trade-offs across an organisation, not single services.

ON THE EXAM

The Associate asks which service. The Professional asks which trade-off, given a constraint somebody else has already fixed.

The format, precisely

- ◆ **75 questions in 180 minutes.** 65 are scored; 10 are unscored trials and are not identified.
- ◆ **Scaled score of 100 to 1,000, with 750 to pass.** Scoring is compensatory: you pass overall, not per domain.
- ◆ **Unanswered scores as incorrect, and guessing carries no penalty.** Never leave a question blank.
- ◆ A list of AWS service short names is available through the **Help button** during the exam.

ON THE EXAM

750 out of 1,000 is not 75%. Scaled scoring means you cannot convert the cut score to a number of questions.

The four domains

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	WHAT IT IS REALLY ABOUT
1 – Organisational Complexity	26%	Many accounts, many teams, one estate
2 – New Solutions	29%	Choosing between defensible designs
3 – Continuous Improvement	25%	Fixing what already runs
4 – Migration and Modernisation	20%	Moving it, and knowing when not to

ON THE EXAM

Domain 4 is 20% of the exam and under 4% of most question banks. It is the most under-prepared domain by a wide margin.

Warning one: this exam retires soon

- ◆ **The last day to take SAP-C02 is 16 November 2026.** Registration for SAP-C03 opens on 27 October.
- ◆ **SAP-C03 moves to five domains**, adding generative and agentic AI, post-quantum cryptography and resilience engineering.
- ◆ **If you are prepared, book now.** The certification is valid for three years whichever version you sit.
- ◆ Retakes need a 14-day wait, so book early enough to fail once and still sit it again before the deadline.

ON THE EXAM

Recorded on 4 September 2026. Check the AWS certification page before booking, because dates do move.

Warning two: some answers no longer exist

- ◆ Migration Hub, Application Discovery Service, the Snow Family, App Runner and Simple AD are all closed to new customers.
- ◆ Every one of them is still on the exam's in-scope list, so every one is still a correct answer.
- ◆ Answer the in-scope list on the day. Knowing more than the exam can genuinely cost you marks.
- ◆ Modules 42 and 43 cover this in full: what was renamed, what closed, and what is simply gone.

ON THE EXAM

If you study alongside current AWS documentation you will hit this contradiction fast. Better to hear it now than at module 33.

How this course was built

- ◆ **The exam guide was fetched live**, so the domain weights and the in-scope service list are the current ones, not remembered.
- ◆ **Every fact was checked against current AWS documentation** while writing. Where something had changed, the module says so.
- ◆ **A 492-question bank was used as a topic map only**, to weight coverage. No question from it is reproduced anywhere.
- ◆ **Every scenario in this course is original**, and most follow one fictional company so the architecture accumulates.

ON THE EXAM

Where AWS's own pages disagreed with each other, the course says so rather than picking one and sounding certain.

How to read the slides

- ◆ **The coloured marker on each bullet is a signal.** Amber for a key fact, red for a trap, teal for a nuance.
- ◆ **The boxed line at the foot of a slide is the exam-facing point,** usually the one property that separates two options.
- ◆ **The bar down the left edge shows which domain you are in,** and moves as the course progresses.
- ◆ Narration carries the reasoning. The slide carries the structure, so listening matters more than reading here.

ON THE EXAM

Nothing important is on a slide and absent from the narration. You can listen to this course without watching it.

The worked scenarios, and the pause

- ◆ **Every teaching module ends with six worked scenarios**, written at the difficulty of the real exam.
- ◆ **When the narration says pause, pause.** Commit to an answer before the walkthrough plays.
- ◆ **Every option gets an explanation**, including the wrong ones, because knowing why a good answer fails is the actual skill.
- ◆ Watching without answering first feels productive and teaches almost nothing.

ON THE EXAM

343 worked scenarios and questions across the course. They are the part that moves your score, not the teaching slides.

The course, measured

SECTION	MODULES	RUNTIME
Domain 1 – Organisational Complexity	02 to 11	2h 53m
Domain 2 – New Solutions	12 to 22	2h 50m
Domain 3 – Continuous Improvement	23 to 32	2h 25m
Domain 4 – Migration and Modernisation	33 to 40	1h 53m
Cross-cutting: pairs, currency, technique	41 to 44	0h 53m
Five practice exams	45 to 49	1h 49m

ON THE EXAM

Teaching runs 10 hours 54 minutes; with the practice exams, about 12 hours 49 minutes. These are measured from the rendered video, not estimated.

Finding your way around

IF YOU WANT

The policy foundations everything rests on

Connectivity, DNS and private access

Choosing between compute, storage, databases

Anything you already run and want to improve

The whole migration domain

Revision, currency and technique

GO TO

00:00 – Guardrails

1:11 – Multi-VPC through 2:20

3:24 – Choosing Compute onward

5:43 – Observability Foundations

8:08 – Portfolio Assessment onward

10:01 – Confusion Pairs onward

ON THE EXAM

Chapter marks are on the video. The four cross-cutting modules from 10:01 are the ones to rewatch in the last week before the exam.

A study route

- ◆ **Watch modules 02 to 44 in order.** Later modules reference earlier ones deliberately, and the scenarios build.
- ◆ **Then sit practice exam 1.** Score it, and rewatch only the modules behind your misses.
- ◆ **Space the remaining exams out.** Taking all five in a weekend measures fatigue rather than knowledge.
- ◆ **Count anything you guessed correctly as a miss.** Otherwise the score flatters you and the gap stays.

ON THE EXAM

Each practice exam ends with a table mapping every question to the module that teaches it, so a miss is immediately actionable.

Two notes on language

- ◆ **The prose is British.** Organisation, optimise, analyse, licence, centre.
- ◆ **AWS product names keep their US spelling.** The pillar is Cost Optimization, and it is AWS Organizations.
- ◆ Mixing those would look like an error to an examiner, so the inconsistency is deliberate.
- ◆ Depth is set for passing the exam, not for implementation. Where more depth exists, the module says where to find it.

ON THE EXAM

Every module ends with a recap slide naming the four things worth carrying out of it. Those are the revision notes.

Module 02 opens Domain 1 at **00:00** with guardrails: SCPs, RCPs and how policies actually evaluate.